Group, Private University[52]). Yet, other students also pointed to the inefficiency of provincial governments in fulfilling their responsibilities.

The discussion on rights and responsibility often veered towards micro and macro issues around sectarianism, provincialism and political corruption, where the importance of the constitution and the duties and responsibilities of the citizen, while acknowledged, were not considered significant enough to challenge the issues facing Pakistan. Hence, for the majority of young Pakistanis in this study, the constitution of Pakistan, while in principle was important, held no practical value for them as citizens.

Views on democracy: The role of the state and the army

When discussing the social contract in Pakistan, the related issue of democracy is never far away. The lack of democracy and the involvement of the army are often used to explain the problems in Pakistan today, including the apathy of the young. Jinnah wanted Pakistan to be a constitutional, parliamentary democracy informed by Muslim values. From independence he assumed control of all key levers of power in Pakistan: governor general, president of the Muslim League, head of the Constituent Assembly; even ardent supporters would concede that the concentration of power set an unfortunate precedent, and when Jinnah died thirteen months later there was no one to fill his shoes. Governance of the country continued to be concentrated in the hands of the elite.

The army became involved in domestic politics early on after independence and Pakistan suffered from three long periods of army rule starting with General Ayub Khan in 1958, when the parliamentary system came to an end for the first time. Corruption had become so widespread within the national and civic systems of administration that Ayub Khan was welcomed as a national hero by the people. He handed over power in 1969 to General Muhammad Yahya Khan, who then oversaw the 1970 elections and the secession of Bangladesh. After six years of democratic rule under Bhutto's PPP, General Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq imposed martial law and the expected elections were postponed. Zia changed Pakistan's constitution so that the democratically elected prime minister became subservient to the president. Democratically elected governments resumed at his death in 1988 and continued for a decade, but none of the four completed their legal term until 2013. General Pervez Musharraf took power in a coup in 1999, claiming that the army was forced to take this step to save the country from 'turmoil and uncertainty'. Given the army's involvement in policing the country and the long periods of army rule with subsequent heavy